

SOUTHERN LATITUDES

THE STARS

Sagittarius and its Milky Way star fields remain high overhead, with Scorpius to the southwest of it. Alpha (α) and Beta (β) Centauri—Rigel Kentaurus (see p.252) and Hadar—are low on the southwestern horizon. To the north are Altair (in Aquila), Vega (in Lyra), and Deneb (in Cygnus), the stars that form the northern Summer Triangle—this is the best time of year to see them in the evening sky from southern latitudes. The Square of Pegasus is rising in the northwest. Fomalhaut, in the constellation Piscis Austrinus, is high in the east, with Achernar, in Eridanus, lower in the southeast. The Small Magellanic Cloud (see p.311) is visible midway between Achernar and the south celestial pole.

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

The best deep-sky objects to view in the southern sky on August evenings are those that passed the

celestial meridian earlier in the year, such as the Lagoon Nebula (see p.243), M22 in Sagittarius, M16 in Serpens Cauda, and M6 and M7 in Scorpius. In addition, this month southern observers can see the Wild Duck Cluster (M11) in Scutum and, looking north of the equator, the Dumbbell Nebula (M27) in Vulpecula and the Ring Nebula (M57) in Lyra (see p.257).



THE LAGOON NEBULA IN SAGITTARIUS
Among the dense star fields of the Milky Way lies the Lagoon Nebula (bottom right), also known as M8, in Sagittarius (right).



POSITIONS OF THE PLANETS

This chart shows the positions of the planets in August from 2020 to 2027. The planets are represented by colored dots, while the number inside each dot denotes the year. For all planets apart from Mercury, the dot indicates the planet's position on August 15. Mercury is shown only when it is at greatest elongation (see p.68)—for the specific date, refer to the table, left.

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|---------|---------|--------|---------|
| Mercury | Mars | Saturn | Neptune |
| Venus | Jupiter | Uranus | |

EXAMPLES

- 23 Jupiter's position on August 15, 2023
- 20 Jupiter's position on August 15, 2020. The arrow indicates that the planet is in retrograde motion (see p.68).

SAGITTARIUS
The Teapot asterism (bottom), formed by eight stars in Sagittarius, is a familiar pattern in summer skies.

